

WHAT WOULD PLATO TWEET?



Twitter has its share of whimsical accounts that give us our daily dose of laughter. But what if Twitter had existed thousands of years ago? This NY Times article has an interesting analysis of social media against the backdrop of Greek philosophy.
<http://dgigit.in/wvPlato>

GOOGLE DRIVE BECOMES CHEAPER



Google reduced the pricing for its cloud storage service Google Drive, and now its about the cheapest cloud storage around. \$1.99 a month will get you 100GB, and \$9.99 per month will get you a full terabyte of cloud storage space!
<http://dgigit.in/wvGoogleDrive>

STREAMING SILENCE ON SPOTIFY

American funk band Vulfpeck has come up with a novel idea - releasing an album that's nothing but silence, and asking their fans to stream it on Spotify every night when they sleep. As Spotify pays the band for every listen, the band hopes to raise enough funds to go on tour.
<http://dgigit.in/wvSpotify>

FLAPPY 2048



Flappy Bird was all the rage last month until the developer took it down. Meanwhile, 2048, a tile-based number game where you need to move tiles to combine them to a sum of 2048 is all the new rage. This website combines both games within a single page!
<http://dgigit.in/wvFlappy>

applications which could be requesting internet data in the background by pinging the servers for requests, ensuring a connection establishment or updating in the background. You should consider killing these applications instead, in order to reduce the energy demands of the device which can be done later on as well. Also, you can restrict background data from the mobile data section to avoid background applications from fetching data and in turn give your battery some boost.

Disable GPS

People are generally smart enough to keep their GPS off when it isn't needed, but what they generally don't do is disable the location reporting and history when they are actually using GPS. These two services are pre-bundled with android and are enabled by default as soon as you turn on your GPS. The motive of these two is not stated clearly anywhere, but they do keep a track of your location and help Google Now and related services use internet to send data to servers. These two, according to Google's help page, are there to improve your experience, but overall they consume a lot of battery power to survey your location. And chances are you are good without these turned on. If you wish to turn these off, you need to go to Settings > Location > Google Location Reporting and disable these.

Moreover, when you are not in need of applications that require your precise location, you can set the mode to battery saving to conserve some battery.

Bluetooth and Wi-Fi

You should keep your Bluetooth and Wi-Fi drivers off when you don't need them to preserve your battery. Also, in case of Wi-Fi, even if it is disabled, the device constantly scans nearby surroundings for

available networks. You should turn it off as well. Head to Wi-Fi settings > Advanced and uncheck the Wi-Fi scanning option. You will have to connect to Wi-Fi manually after doing so but it's worth the effort to prevent it from hogging on your device for power.

Wallpapers and Themes

Live wallpapers are a flashy and fun thing to have on your device's home screen, but again they take too much battery and you should consider not using them if you really want your battery to last longer.

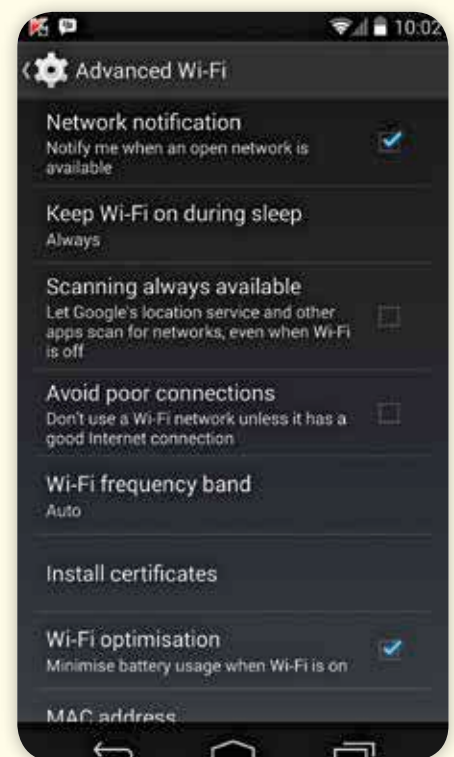
Also, using the default launcher for your device uses lesser footprint (Google Now Launcher) as compared to other launchers and you should switch to it just in case you are low on battery.

Darker themes consume lesser battery as compared to brighter ones.

Disable Google Now cards

Google Now is a great assistant to have and once you start using it, you will find that it is unmatched in quality. Although you may not use all of the Google Now services, they still keep running in the background. So you might wish to avoid the battery drain by disabling the informational cards. For example, "Nearby Places" card, which is a seemingly cool feature, gives you the hangout places nearby that you don't usually travel to. I think it is unnecessary and one could live without it turned on.

To disable specific cards, go to Now, scroll to the very bottom and touch the magic wand icon located at the lower center of the screen. From here you can customize the cards you need and disable the ones you don't. As a thumb rule, cards relying on GPS (such as Travel Time, Nearby Places etc.) will drain more battery. So you can disable those to boost your battery a bit.



Why scan for Wi-Fi when you don't need to?

Sync

Sync is a feature in which your device constantly contacts Google's servers for downloading emails, calendar records and other information in the background. This uses loads of battery power and you should shut it down when it is not needed. Don't worry; everything will be synced later when you turn it on again.

Note: If you are really low on battery, switching to airplane mode is the best way to save some battery to be used later when it's crucial.

If you are still unsure of what is draining your device's battery and wish to monitor battery usage statistics by various applications, you can do so in the battery section of the settings. 